

B.E.T.Trade

Killzones

Course notes - Lessons 04.1 to 04.4

London Open · New York AM · the Silver Bullet

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Notes generated from the B.E.T.Trade Forex course, built from the author's own trading plan and journal. For the full lessons with video walkthroughs, see the Pro tier.

Time & the killzone map

Most traders obsess over the perfect entry and ignore the one variable that decides whether it works: time. Start here - the exact New York windows and macro slots where forex is actually programmed to move.

~6 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

The edge is TIME. Set your charts to New York time. Two windows matter for forex: **London Open 02:00-05:00** and **New York AM 08:30-11:00**. The macros are the 10-minute sniper slots inside them - right hour, right ten minutes.

Intro - why your "perfect" setup keeps failing

You found a clean MSS, a beautiful FVG, the bias lined up - and it still stopped you out. Sound familiar? Nine times out of ten the setup wasn't the problem. **The time of day was.**

This is the single biggest lesson in my notes, written in red: **if it's not the right time of day, it won't work.** The algorithm that delivers price runs on a schedule. The exact same MSS-plus-FVG is a coin flip at 13:00 and an actual edge at 09:50. Killzones are how you stop gambling on good-looking charts and start trading *when the market is actually programmed to move.*

Everything here comes from how I personally trade and journal it - the times, the macros, the sweep play, and the Silver Bullet. Learn the clock and your win rate fixes itself.

The only clock that matters - New York time

Every single time in this lesson is **New York local time (EST/EDT)**. Not your broker's time, not your local time - New York. The first thing you do is set your chart timezone to New York and never touch it again. Half of trader confusion about "when is London open" disappears the moment your candles line up with the windows below.

Set your chart to New York time first. Every killzone and macro below is NY local time. Get this wrong and every window in your plan is off by hours.

The killzone map - the master table

This is the backbone straight out of my trading plan. Memorize it. The two you actually trade forex in are highlighted in your head: **London Open** and **New York AM**.

Killzone	Time (NY)	What it's for
Midnight Open	00:00	Daily reference / true day open
London Open	02:00 - 05:00	Prime - first real liquidity
New York AM	08:30 - 11:00	Prime - the main event
New York Lunch	12:00 - 13:00	Dead zone - avoid
New York PM	13:30 - 16:00	Continuation / second chance

Killzone	Time (NY)	What it's for
Power Hour	15:00 - 16:00	Late-day push
Asia Range	20:00 - 00:00	Builds the liquidity London hunts

Notice the rhythm: **Asia builds the range, London sweeps it, New York sweeps London.** Liquidity is created in one session and harvested in the next. That single sentence is most of forex killzone trading.

Important times *inside* the day

Three clock points to keep on your radar - they inject volatility and often kick off the move inside a killzone:

- **08:30 NY - News release.** High-impact data drops - in my notes these count as **manual intervention**: FOMC, PPI, CPI, NFP. Displacement after 08:30 sets the tone for the AM session.
- **09:30 NY - US equities open.** The "Judas Swing" lives here - a fake move just before the open that traps retail before the real direction.
- **03:00 NY - London stock market open.** Adds fuel to the London killzone.

Macros - the *sniper windows*

Inside each killzone there are tighter slots where the algorithm actually runs price - the **macros**. If killzones are the right hour, macros are the right ten minutes. These are the exact windows from my plan:

Session	Macro windows (NY)
London	02:33 - 03:00 · 04:03 - 04:30
New York AM	08:50 - 09:10 · 09:50 - 10:10 · 10:50 - 11:10
NY Lunch + PM	11:50 - 12:10 · 13:10 - 13:40 · 15:15 - 15:45

Taking setups inside killzones AND macro slots stacks probability - as long as your draw on liquidity and your stop placement are right. Right time plus right liquidity is the whole game.

Sweep, then go

The bread-and-butter killzone play in one idea: one session takes the liquidity built by another, then reverses. Your job is to trade the reversal, not the sweep.

~6 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

One session builds liquidity, the next killzone **sweeps it and reverses**. You trade the reversal after the sweep: sweep, then MSS, then FVG entry - inside the killzone. Primed (sloping) pools are the ones the algorithm reaches for.

The core play - sweep, then go

Here is the bread and butter, the thing that shows up in my journal over and over. One session builds an obvious pool of liquidity - equal highs, equal lows, a session high/low. The next killzone **sweeps that liquidity** and then reverses into the real move. You are not trading the sweep. You are trading the reversal *after* the sweep.

The mechanical version: wait for the liquidity grab, then look for a Market Structure Shift (MSS) on your execution timeframe, then enter on the FVG/PD array it leaves behind - inside the killzone. Sweep first, then structure, then entry.

FROM THE JOURNAL - NY AM SILVER BULLET

Before 10:00, price took the **BSL from the London session**. SIBI sitting in premium, then an **MSS** and a retracement back into that SIBI - entry there, target the NWOGL low. Right session, swept liquidity, structure shift, clean target. Result: a winner around +1.4R.

FROM THE JOURNAL - ASIA SWEEP INTO NY

Price swept the **15-minute SSL from the Asia session**, then printed an MSS and left an FVG. Entry in that FVG. Same skeleton as above, different liquidity source - the point is the sweep came first, the structure confirmed it, and the entry sat inside the killzone.

Pre-market & opening range - 3 shots per session

This is the ICT framework I drill. Each session gives you about **three** chances, built around 30-minute boxes:

- **Pre-market range:** 07:00-07:30 · 08:00-08:30 · 09:00-09:30. Draw a 30-minute box, hunt the equal highs/lows formed before it on the 15/5/1-minute timeframes.
- **Opening range:** 07:30-08:00 · 08:30-09:00 · 09:30-10:00.

Across those slots you get roughly three real opportunities a session. The whole time you are looking for the same thing: **where is the market smooth** (clean, one-sided liquidity) so a sweep there has somewhere to run.

How to know a pool will get swept

Not every bit of liquidity gets taken. From my notes, the tells that a pool is primed for the algorithm:

- **Priming on highs:** the swing high on the left is *higher* than the one on the right - that downward-sloping pair of highs is exactly where retail stacks stops.
- **Priming on lows:** the swing low on the left is *lower* than the one on the right.
- These primed pools are what the algorithm reaches for - but liquidity sitting there does **not** guarantee it gets taken this session. You stack confluences (right killzone, right macro, draw on liquidity) to raise the odds.

The Silver Bullet & Judas

The single highest-probability window of my trading day, and the fake-out that comes right before the real move. If 09:30 is a mess, this lesson is where the patience pays off.

~7 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

The **Silver Bullet (10:00-11:00 NY)** is the highest-probability hour - when 09:30 is muddy, wait for it. And expect a **Judas Swing**: a fake move that clears stops before the real one, at both the London and NY opens.

The Silver Bullet - 10:00 to 11:00 NY

If you only learn one window, learn this one. The **Silver Bullet runs roughly 10:00-11:00 NY** and it is the highest-probability slot of my day. My own rule, straight from the notes: **when the chart is muddy from the 09:30 open, stop forcing it and wait for 10:00**. The Silver Bullet hour cleans up the mess and hands you a setup.

The recipe is always the same - a recent liquidity pool gets swept, you get a displacement/MSS, and you enter on the FVG it leaves, ideally inside the 09:50-10:10 macro. Patience until 10:00 has saved more of my sessions than any indicator ever did.

Muddy, choppy, no clean read after 09:30? Do not force a trade. Wait for the 10:00 Silver Bullet - that is the plan, not an excuse.

The Judas Swing - the *fake before the real move*

This is the thread running through every killzone in my journal: the algorithm already knows where the **High of the Day** and the **Low of the Day** will be. Before it delivers the real move it runs a **Judas Swing** - a fake push in the wrong direction to clear stops and trap people on the wrong side. If I am bullish, I want to see a soft rally into buy-side stops that looks like continuation, then a drop that stops out everyone who chased - *then* the real move up.

It shows up at both prime opens: a Judas push just after the **02:00 London open**, and the classic fake right before the **09:30 equities open**. The tell from my notes is that the market gets very **smooth on one side** before the open - clean, primed liquidity sitting there for the algorithm to take. Do not trade the Judas. Let it complete, then trade the reversal.

One named setup I track here is the **9:30 1st PFVG** - the first Fair Value Gap presented right after the 09:30 open. It can be a high-quality entry, but it is conditional: it works when the open delivers a clean displacement away from swept liquidity, and it is a trap when 09:30 is choppy and directionless - which is your cue to wait for the 10:00 Silver Bullet instead.

FROM THE JOURNAL - LONDON OPEN JUDAS INTO A SHORT

After the **02:00 London open** there was a Judas Swing up, then on the news a drop. I waited for a soft pullback into the FVG it left behind - around the 0.25 zone - where a BISI got broken by a SIBI, so I traded it as an **IFVG**. Short from there, targeting the SSL below: three equal lows from the prior day. Right killzone, fake cleared, structure shifted, clean liquidity target.

Sessions & discipline

The two killzones you actually trade forex in, what to do in each, and the most underrated skill in trading: knowing exactly when to do nothing.

~6 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

London marks and sweeps the **Asia range**; **NY AM is the main event**. NY Lunch (12:00-13:00) is dead - don't trade it. Half the edge is the discipline of knowing when to sit on your hands.

London Open killzone - 02:00-05:00 NY

London is the first real liquidity of the day. Your job before it opens is simple: **mark the Asia range high and low**. London will usually reach for one side, sweep it, and then reveal direction. Tighten your focus to the macros at **02:33-03:00** and **04:03-04:30**.

One hard-earned caution from my journal: **the end of the London session is awkward to trade**. If price has only gone one direction all session - say it dumped all morning and you're holding a bullish bias - be very careful late in London. Don't fight a session that's run one way into its close. Mark it, wait for New York.

FROM THE JOURNAL - TARGETING LONDON LIQUIDITY

Price pulled back and respected a level, so the entry was a long - **targeting the London session equal highs** as the draw on liquidity. The London highs/lows aren't just decoration; they are the magnet the next session aims for.

New York AM killzone - 08:30-11:00 NY

This is the main event for forex. The structure of the morning, the way I trade it:

- **08:30 - news + displacement**. After the release, watch the old highs, old lows and inefficiencies. The candle that sweeps recent equal highs/lows and then displaces is your orderblock - equal lows taken gives a bearish candle, equal highs taken gives a bullish one.
- **09:30 - equities open + Judas Swing**. A rapid fake move into a breaker just before 09:30 is classic - it traps retail, then reverses.
- **10:00 - Silver Bullet**. If 08:30-09:30 was clean, you may already be in. If it was muddy, this is your window.

NY Lunch & PM - when NOT to enter

Knowing when to do nothing is half the edge. **NY Lunch (12:00-13:00) is a dead zone** - liquidity thins out, moves get choppy, and most "setups" there are traps. Step away.

The **PM session (13:30-16:00)** is a second chance, not a fresh start. My approach: wait for a pullback to the **1st PFVG** and read what price does there before committing. The macro slots to respect are **13:10-13:40** and, into Power Hour, **15:15-15:45**.

The discipline - *when to sit on your hands*

If you tape one list to your monitor, make it this one:

1. **Outside the killzones.** No London Open, no NY AM, no PM macro - no trade.
2. **NY Lunch (12:00-13:00).** Just don't.
3. **End of London** if it only trended one way against your bias.
4. **Muddy chart after 09:30** - wait for the 10:00 Silver Bullet instead of forcing it.
5. **No clean draw on liquidity** - if there's no obvious pool to target, there's no trade.
6. **No sweep, no MSS** - structure has to confirm before you click. Sweep first.

Your killzone cheatsheet

Screenshot this and keep it next to your charts:

Window (NY)	Name	Play
02:00-05:00	London Open	Mark Asia range, trade the sweep
02:33-03:00	London macro	Sniper slot 1
04:03-04:30	London macro	Sniper slot 2
08:30	News	Displacement, find the orderblock
09:30	Equities open	Watch the Judas Swing
09:50-10:10	AM macro	Silver Bullet core
10:00-11:00	Silver Bullet	Highest-probability hour
12:00-13:00	NY Lunch	Do nothing
13:30-16:00	NY PM	Pullback to 1st PFVG

Last words - *set your clock and wait*

Killzones are not a secret indicator - they are **discipline with a timestamp**. Everything you already learned (bias on the higher timeframes, liquidity sweeps, MSS, FVG entries) only fires properly inside these windows. Set your chart to New York time, mark the Asia and London ranges, hunt only in London Open and NY AM, respect the macros, and when in doubt, wait for 10:00.

Do this for one week: trade *only* the London Open and NY AM killzones, and journal the time of every entry the way I do. You will watch your "random" losses outside those windows vanish - because they were never random, they were just badly timed. Right setup, right time. That's the whole edge.